COUNTRY REPORTS: GABON

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Status report

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Gabon's digital budget was enacted below what was asked and then cut. Against 82bn CFA francs presented for 2026, the 2026 finance law voted 62.4bn CFA francs to the digital-economy programme and the supplementary law of 17 July 2026 cut it to 49.8bn, while disbursement on the World Bank-financed eGabon and Gabon Digital programmes was still too low in February 2026, the ministry judging the foundations in place and interministerial coordination in need of strengthening.

The commitments themselves are thinner than the money implies. Gabon has a current national digital transformation strategy, but a whole-of-government approach to public sector digital transformation only planned or in draft. The digital economy minister presented the orientations of a national digitalisation strategy to the state's information-system directors on 3 April 2026, on five axes - regulation, infrastructure, digitised public services, local skills and data governance - with sector master plans to follow; no strategy text is published. There is a ministry leading the work and a cross-government forum at which senior digital officials meet, though progress against the transformation programme is reported internally and not published. And there is no government entity responsible for data governance, no data governance strategy or policy, and nothing published on how government data is governed — an absence sitting directly beneath a programme whose stated purpose is interconnecting state systems.

Delivery is steered rather than owned. A comité de pilotage held its fifth session in February 2026, and a World Bank mission met ANINF in June 2026 to review the closure of the e-Gabon project and the execution of Gabon Digital. Instructions arrive as one-off directives: a presidential directive of 3 October 2025 called for the financial agencies to be digitised. The framing throughout is sovereignty — the SecBOM cybersecurity initiative is driven from the Presidency and combines technical, legal-compliance and sovereigntist objectives, and the digital economy minister presents the e-government ordinance as a major reform bringing public services closer to citizens and stimulating digital sovereignty. The ministry's next-phase priorities, reviewed in July 2026, are governance of digital projects, the GabIX exchange point, infrastructure, an institutional content strategy and digital diplomacy.

The administration that has to deliver all this is Gabon's weak point: Public Administration is its lowest-ranked IIAG sub-category at 38.4 of 100 in 2023, 45th of 54 African states, against an overall governance score of 46.6, 32nd of 54 and below the African average of 49.3.

Legislation and regulation

Gabon's data protection law cites the wrong article in its own exceptions to the ban on sensitive data. Article 75 of loi n°025/2023 of 12 July 2023 prohibits outright the collection or processing of biometric and genetic data, alongside racial and ethnic origin, political, philosophical and religious opinion, union membership, health and sexual life, but

the derogations article 76 lists are written against "l'interdiction prévue par l'article 74", which governs children's data, while state processing of the biometric data needed to authenticate or check identity is authorised by decree in the Council of Ministers after the authority's opinion (article 83). The same law binds controllers from its publication on 15 July 2023, with no transition period, so every system already running when it appeared was in scope on day one; it amends the 2011 statute that first created the regime and is the instrument now governing personal data.

The rest of the digital statute book is more conventional. Electronic communications run under Law No. 026/2018; a dedicated law regulates electronic transactions, taking in data protection, digital identification and digital payments; and the 2023 cybersecurity and cybercrime law imposes data localisation on electronic communications operators. Identity and civil status are extensively legislated: enrolment for the personal identification number is compulsory for every person present on Gabonese territory, the 2025 electoral code builds the roll from the national biometric register, and Law 008/2022 provides for a centralised, digital and biometric civil registry.

Two recent instruments matter most. An ordinance published in the Journal Officiel of 7 September 2025 gives e-government its first comprehensive legal basis, requiring public administrations to digitise services, interconnect systems and bring in the private sector. An ordonnance published on 8 April 2026 fixes the digital age of majority at sixteen and bars social-media account creation below it, and civil society is asking for provisions of the regulation in force that it judges disproportionate to be revised. The largest hole is older: Gabon has no right-to-information law, and none in draft. Draft texts on digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, digital services and the institutional framework went to a validation review of about ten days at Nkok from 1 October 2026, under the World Bank-financed digital programme; the texts are not held.

Data protection

Gabon funds data protection through a levy collected by data controllers. The 2023 law keeps a levy on controllers and their processors but leaves its base and rate to the finance law and its split to a joint ministerial order, and the 2025 finance law instituted it on every person whose data a public or private body in Gabon processes, forecasting 2.92bn CFA francs of receipts; its rate is not on the record. An ordonnance of 31 January 2020 had set the earlier levy at 1,000 FCFA per person per year, split 40% to the state and 60% to the authority. The regime it funds is loi n°025/2023 of 12 July 2023, supervised by the Autorité pour la Protection des Données Personnelles et de la Vie Privée, an independent authority covering public and private processing alike.

The law's starting position on biometrics is prohibition, not regulation: processing biometric data is barred outright, state processing of biometric data to authenticate identity needs a decree issued after the authority's opinion, and automated processing must generally be declared to the APDPVP. The authority has used that machinery. It fined Citibank Gabon 90m CFA francs in April 2024 for diverting employee data from its declared purpose in an internal inquiry. Deliberation No. 026 of 14 November 2023 approved the extraction of personal data from the IBOGA biometric system for the electronic identity card, and named the directorate handling access and rectification requests. It accompanied the national data centre for months before commissioning, and the operator thanked it, with the government, for support in obtaining the authorisations the launch required (June 2026). And on 20 January 2026 it oversaw the destruction of the personal files of unsuccessful 2022 public-tender bidders held by the Direction générale des Marchés publics, after the retention period had run — an occasion its rapporteur used to tell public bodies to destroy sensitive documents before witnesses under the authority's supervision rather than store them loosely.

The individual's side is weaker. Access to one's own data is a free written request under Article 43, though a copy may be charged at no more than the cost of reproduction (Article 44); breach notification to the authority is mandatory and without delay; transfers to countries without adequate protection are barred, but no adequacy list has been published, the authority instead authorising transfers bank by bank, Citibank Gabon's staff data to Sweden

and Canada for one year among them (March 2024); and nothing is published on complaints received or on the regulator's performance. One protection is contractual rather than statutory: a covenant of the World Bank-financed identity programme requires the biometric population registry, the civil register and the identity card database to stay functionally separate. Against all of that, Digital Freedom fell 19.5 points over 2014-2023 to 38.3 of 100, 42nd of 54 African states, the fourth most deteriorated of Gabon's 96 IIAG indicators.

Regional collaboration

Gabon's digital estate reaches across its borders mainly through institutions it does not run. Its payments build sits on GIMACPAY, the CEMAC regional instant payment system run by GIMAC, with the central bank BEAC as majority owner and settlement agent, a system live since July 2020 that treats cross-border transfers within the monetary union on the same basis as domestic ones. The backbone was built the same way, under the regional Central African Backbone programme, whose Gabon operation closed in 2020.

That dependence is not matched by integration more broadly. Regional Integration scored 25.4 of 100 in 2023, 46th of 54 African states, despite rising 9.7 points over the decade, and ECCAS is Gabon's only regional economic community membership.

Where Gabon has moved is on rules and enforcement rather than systems. It signed the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime in September 2026, not yet ratified, and it took part in Interpol's Serengeti 2.0 cybercrime operation alongside 17 other African countries between June and August 2025. A digital diplomacy workstream covering candidacy for International Telecommunication Union governance bodies and participation in the African Digital Ministers' Council was named a ministerial priority in July 2026.

Standards

The only interoperability framework Gabon has published governs one sector: the CI-SIS health information interoperability framework, first issued in 2019 under the 2017 master plan for health information systems. Across government there is no interoperability framework setting the rules for data exchange between state systems, which means systems are still specified one at a time.

Nothing else fills the gap. Gabon has no data quality framework for government information systems, no monitoring of their uptime, no guidance for replacing legacy systems, and publishes nothing on interoperability compliance. The procurement lever that would enforce standards is absent too: there is no e-procurement portal, so tendering and contract award are not conducted online and procurement enforces no interoperability or technical standards. On software, there is no open source policy or action plan for the public sector and no body deciding on open source adoption or procurement.

Formal standardisation sits with AGANOR, created by decree in June 2014 as the national body for standards, conformity assessment, metrology and quality, which ISO lists as Gabon's member, participating in 3 technical committees and observing 18 (October 2026); no information-technology standard from it is on record.

The one common standard that does exist is fiscal, and it stops halfway: a unified budget classification and chart of accounts covers central government only, and does not extend to sub-national government.

Of the core administrative systems Gabon does operate — financial management, tax and customs among them — none has recorded governance arrangements covering compliance, security and audit trails over its operations (2025).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Deliberative and Participatory Governance is the second most deteriorated of Gabon's 96 IIAG indicators, down 22.0 points over 2014-2023 to 46.5 of 100 in 2023, 35th of 54 African states. The space for civil society has widened over the same decade — Civil Society Space rose 9.9 points to 67.8, 17th of 54 — while the Participation sub-category fell 5.2 points to 38.4: organisations can operate, but what they say does not reach the decision.

There is no digital channel for it either. Gabon has no national platform through which citizens or businesses can take part in policy decisions, submit petitions or give anonymous feedback, and no platform for lodging complaints, suggestions or information requests about service delivery, no published service standards and no demonstration that feedback is acted on. Gabon scored 0.1233 on the UN E-Participation Index in 2024, far below its overall e-government score.

None of the four public service portals the GovTech Maturity Index assesses in Gabon involves citizens in the design of its services (2025).

Speech itself is under pressure. Freedom of Expression and Belief fell 17.0 points over 2014-2023 to 60.1 of 100, and social media had been suspended for nearly five months when the presidency defended the measure as temporary at a Libreville press conference on 17 July 2026, rejecting a purely political reading of it and framing it as regulation and protection of the young. Advocacy has filled some of the vacuum: APSAD presented a report on civic and digital liberties at Libreville on 25 July 2026, built from two months of consultations with civil-society organisations, journalists, bloggers and digital-sector operators, asking the state to end blanket social-media suspensions, revise provisions of the regulation in force it judges disproportionate, strengthen the Haute Autorité de la Communication's independence and open a standing dialogue with the sector. Consultation that does happen leaves little trace: when the ministry postponed the Kimba Connect final on 6 August 2026 over start-up concerns, it described the objections only as concerning the programme's organisation, and no start-up was named or quoted, leaving the complaint on the record only through the body it was aimed at. The suspension was reported still in force on 6 October 2026, after the presidential spokesman said on radio that he gets round it with a virtual private network. Paradigm Initiative asked the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights on 13 October 2026 to call on Gabon to amend the April ordinance's blanket ban on under-16s using social media.

Finance

Financial sustainability

Gabon has put its fibre backbone on private money under state ownership: on 14 September 2026 the state holding SPIN signed a 20-year public-private partnership with Gabon Fiber S.A., leasing it about 1,800 km of existing network that remains SPIN's property and conceding a 1,700 km extension the company designs, finances, builds and operates. The extensions revert to SPIN at the end of the term and operators get open, non-discriminatory access, and the concessionaire plans to raise more than 41 billion CFA francs on international markets so that the build does not touch the state budget (September 2026).

Domestic money carries 60.7 per cent of the digital lines in Gabon's 2026 budget as revised by the supplementary law of July 2026, 31.3 billion of 51.6 billion CFA francs, against 52.9 per cent of 48.7 billion in the 2025 finance law as voted.

Much of the domestic side is earmarked receipts rather than tax. The 2026 laws attribute 6.82 billion CFA francs of spectrum-management receipts to ANINF and 4.01 billion of regulation receipts to ARCEP back to the digital-economy programme, fund 3.81 billion of universal-service spending from a special account, and concede to the

data-protection authority 2.92 billion of its levy on data controllers; the universal-service account is fed by the universal-service levy, a spectrum fee and ARCEP's receipts (2025). Since August 2025 a ministry that has not sent its annual digitalisation plan can be refused the budget entry and the public contracts for its digital projects.

The loans moved the other way in July 2026: the supplementary law cut the Gabon Digital drawing from 8 billion to 5 billion CFA francs and added a 6 billion commercial loan from Standard Chartered and Citi for a national data centre and other digital works. The World Bank's Digital Gabon credit had a closing date of 30 June 2026. No outturn against the digital appropriations had been published as at September 2026.

MoUs and other agreements

Gabon signed an accord with the Société Gabonaise de Garantie on 14 July 2026 to establish guarantee mechanisms that would cut the risk banks bear in lending to young innovative firms, its director-general Alban Etho putting risk-sharing as the condition for improving start-up access to bank credit. It has no published guarantee ceiling, coverage ratio, eligibility test, term or participating banks, and the skills accord signed with Huawei Technologies Gabon the same day — smart rooms for innovation, training in networks, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and software development, and access to the company's certifying training kits — has no room count, trainee target, cost or duration.

That is the pattern across the rest. Gabon signed a memorandum of understanding with Huawei in 2024 for a smart-cities project and other digital services, carrying a pledge of spending rather than a financing agreement, and the July 2026 skills accord follows a broader memorandum signed on 23 December 2025 on national digital transformation, which expands the Connected Schools programme, leaving one vendor as the standing technical partner at both the infrastructure and the skills layer. ANINF and ST Digital signed a framework agreement in July 2025 covering secure digital infrastructure, cloud, cybersecurity, digital identity and e-government with local capacity-building; no value, delivery date or committed scope of work attaches to it, which makes it a statement of intent. A partnership with Visa, agreed in May 2025 and followed up in Libreville on 18 July 2025, is directed at digitalising public services and modernising how the state collects payments, again with no value attached.

The exception is with a development agency rather than a vendor: Gabon signed an agreement with the UN Capital Development Fund in December 2025 to modernise its financial services and widen financial inclusion.

New investments

Seven per cent of the roughly 44 billion CFA francs of World Bank financing behind the eGabon and Gabon Digital programmes had been disbursed by the fifth steering committee in February 2026, up from 3% the previous May, with the ministry recording that the foundations were in place but the disbursement rate too low.

The largest live commitment is the Digital Gabon Project, about US$68 million of IBRD lending approved in July 2021 with a closing date of 30 June 2026, for connectivity, digital government services, digital financial infrastructure and the ICT sector. Its 2021 appraised design puts US$24.5 million into modernising legal identity systems — the largest component — US$20 million into the enabling environment, US$17 million into public administration and services and US$7 million into citizen engagement, implementation support and monitoring. eGabon adds about US$56 million, approved in June 2016 with a closing date of August 2025, most of it appraised for a national health information system alongside the digital innovation sector. Two older loans have closed: US$50 million for statistical system modernisation, approved in 2017 and closed in 2023, and about US$23 million of additional financing for the Central African Backbone build, closed in 2020.

The rest is small, or is not money into the country. MIGA approved about US$28 million of political-risk cover in December 2021 over a private-equity stake in Airtel Mobile Commerce's Gabonese subsidiary, insuring the Airtel Money wallet business against war, expropriation and inconvertibility. The U.S. Department of State is funding about US$1.25 million of cybersecurity capacity-building with ANINF over 2024-2025, and the ITU ran a CHF 1.24 million regional project between 2021 and 2023 on ICT indicators with CEMAC regulators and statistics offices, Gabon among eight target countries.

Nine commitments and pledges are on the record, made between 2016 and 2026 by six financiers. Around US$227 million of that is finance actually committed as at October 2026, and about US$197 million of it is four IBRD loans — non-concessional sovereign borrowing, with grant money amounting to two small awards, one of undisclosed size. Five commitments were still live as at October 2026, four of them worth roughly US$126 million and the fifth undisclosed; the smallest of them is the one private equity round. Connectivity and e-government take most of the recorded total, and the largest figure of all is a private pledge under a memorandum rather than a financing agreement.

The lender's restructuring paper of June 2026 records US$13.38m disbursed by 31 May 2026, rates progress towards the objective moderately unsatisfactory and keeps the civil-registration digitisation component unchanged.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Coverage has stopped being Gabon's constraint. Some 98% of the population had at least a 4G signal in 2022, the regulator put telephone and internet coverage at 97% in 2024, with over two million internet and mobile subscribers, and there are now around 124 mobile connections per 100 people (2025), 88.9% of them capable of 3G or better (November 2025). Set against that, about 71.9% of the population used the internet in 2023, and territorial coverage is not the same as usable service: rural primary clinics were still keeping patient records on paper in 2022, held there by unreliable connectivity and a shortage of computers. Access also runs on terms the state sets, and the suspension of social media was reported still in force on 6 October 2026.

The decade-long trend is one of the strongest on the continent. Gabon's Internet and Computers score rose 23.3 points over 2014-2023 to 48.5 of 100, 14th of 54 African states and the third most improved of its 96 governance indicators, mobile communications stood at 74.2, 17th of 54, and the country scored 76.1 on the ITU's ICT Development Index in 2024, 11th in Africa. Infrastructure is the best-ranked sub-category in a parent category that ranks 42nd, at 46.6 of 100 and 18th of 54. What the public makes of it points the other way: public perception of infrastructure is one of Gabon's ten worst indicators at 12.2 of 100 in 2023, having fallen 17.9 points over the decade.

The backbone is also a single thread: on 24 August 2026 several sections of the national fibre backbone were cut along the railway near Lopé, taking internet, mobile and fixed telephony down across four interior provinces, whether by accident or sabotage not established. The remaining gap is physical. Fibre cannot reach everywhere in a country with 88% forest cover, which is the case a national policy process on satellite communications opened in July 2026 is built on. Domestic traffic exchange remains thin: GABIX, the national internet exchange point, had 8 members in September 2026, and its development is still a named priority of the digital economy ministry (July 2026). The sector operates under Law No. 026/2018, with the backbone built under a regional programme that closed in 2020 and the World Bank's Digital Gabon operation, whose closing date was 30 June 2026. The incumbent operator and the ministry signed a convention ceding to the State the 196 km Fougamou-Mouila fibre section (2026), within a twenty-year public-private partnership signed in September 2026 for a private operator to run and

extend the national backbone, which says it intends to raise more than 41bn CFA francs to build 1,650 km of fibre. The state infrastructure holding and Cameroon's state operator signed a memorandum on a terrestrial interconnection of Cameroon, Gabon and Congo over the Central African Backbone (October 2026). Airtel Gabon put FDD+TDD Massive MIMO into commercial service on its 4G network on 13 October 2026 as groundwork for 5G, whose conditions the regulator discussed with both mobile operators in December 2025.

Data Storage

Gabon's first Tier III certified data centre opened in July 2026 in the Nkok special economic zone near Libreville, inaugurated by President Brice Oligui Nguema. It was built by the Cameroonian operator ST Digital on a roughly 3,000 square metre site, with capacity for around 3,000 physical servers across cloud, colocation and private suite halls, and an entirely Gabonese technical staff — the sovereign facility is thus the work of a foreign builder run by Gabonese engineers. It commissions 92 racks on 1 MW of installed electrical power and is connected to the ACE and the South Africa Far East/West Africa submarine cable systems, at a cost of about 8 billion CFA francs, some US$14 million (July 2026), eleven months after ground was broken in August 2025.

The state has made domestic hosting the explicit basis of its digital sovereignty policy, presenting the launch as a way to store sensitive government and business data at home and reduce reliance on foreign digital infrastructure, the dependence on servers abroad it is meant to close. A separate national data centre for ANINF is planned with the US firm Cybastion, under a cooperation convention the head of state formalised in June 2025 and a strategic agreement with the digital economy ministry for a 20 MW facility; no cost or completion date is published. The data protection authority was a real gate rather than a formality: the APDPVP accompanied the project for months to verify compliance before commissioning, and ST Digital thanked it, with the government, for support in obtaining the authorisations the launch required.

The binding rules are older than the building. Law No. 027/2023 requires electronic communications network operators to run an operational management centre for their infrastructure and data on national territory (Article 22), confidential or sensitive data to be hosted exclusively in Gabon absent a written exemption (Article 27), and every operator to keep a copy of its data in the country (Article 36). Government's own hosting is the weaker half. Gabon has no shared cloud platform available across government entities, and no platform type or cloud service is recorded for it (2025), with nothing published on where government data may be held or on government cloud usage, even though the World Bank's eGabon operation, approved in 2016, lists a government data centre among the e-government infrastructure it develops. Nor does the new capacity change the hyperscaler picture: Gabon has no direct cloud on-ramp for AWS, Azure or Google Cloud, so enterprises reach those services over interconnects to Lagos or Cape Town at latencies above 100 milliseconds (September 2025).

Energy

Gabon has close to universal electricity access and a supply that does not hold. Frequent outages and regular load shedding in the capital drew public anger in 2025, in a country where 94.1% of the population had access to electricity in 2023 and access to energy is one of its ten best-scoring governance indicators at 91.2 of 100, 7th of 54 African states. Access measured that way says nothing about whether the power stays on, which is the property a data centre or a government system depends on.

The national average also conceals the geography. Electricity reached 99.2% of the urban population in 2023 but only 29.0% of the rural population, a gap of some seventy percentage points that tracks the concentration of grid supply in Libreville and the other towns — and therefore sets the outer limit on where any digital service that needs mains power can operate. For those on the grid, residential electricity cost about US$0.214 per kilowatt hour in December 2025, so a benchmark 100 kWh month absorbs roughly 3% of income per head.

Technical Capacity

Gabon has the institutional furniture of a digital state and publishes none of its results. The GovTech Maturity Index records a ministry leading public sector digital transformation and a cross-government forum at which senior digital officials address digital, data, technology and capacity questions across the state, with progress against the transformation programme reported internally and not published (2025), alongside an established GovTech entity, a coordination body leading GovTech initiatives and an entity monitoring digital spending across government — whose annual progress report is likewise internal. Gabon scores better on those institutional measures than on almost anything else the index asks of it.

The administration underneath them is a weak point. Public Administration is Gabon's lowest-ranked governance sub-category, at 38.4 of 100 in 2023 and 45th of 54 African states, despite improving 3.0 points over the decade, and effective administration scored 46.7, 33rd of 54, essentially flat across 2014-2023. Delivery runs through ANINF, whose deputy director-general coordinates the World Bank-financed eGabon-SIS project and Gabon Digital programme, which opened its first office outside Libreville, in Franceville, in June 2026. The operating disciplines are thinner than the institutions: no data quality framework for government information systems, no uptime monitoring, no guidance for replacing legacy systems, and nothing published on interoperability compliance.

The pipeline exists and is largely untested in public. The Université Numérique du Gabon, a public distance-learning university, awards state-recognised degrees in disciplines that include computer science and engineering sciences (2025). Where systems are running, capability is shared with suppliers — the electronic identity card and its digital identity management software and hardware are supplied by the French company IN Groupe (2024) — and external money is going into the state's own skills: the US State Department is funding about US$1.25 million of cybersecurity capacity-building with ANINF across 2024-2025, aimed at national frameworks, incident response and digital resilience.

Cybersecurity

A cyberattack on the night of 14 to 15 June 2026 brought down close to 95% of the information systems of the water and electricity utility SEEG, including the platform selling prepaid-meter units, and on 4 August the company reported billing and payment restored in Libreville and seven interior centres, the attackers still unidentified. The government raised its vigilance level in September 2026 after more than 900,000 intrusion alerts were recorded in sixty days, and ANINF answered that the figure shows a system able to see threats, not 900,000 compromises.

The law is further ahead than the machine: Gabon scored 39.85 of 100 on the ITU Global Cybersecurity Index in 2024, up from 11.38 in the 2020 edition — a rise that still leaves it in the index's Tier 4, with full marks on legal measures and weak technical, organisational and cooperation measures. The operational side is where the gap shows: a dedicated security operations centre for government systems was still planned rather than running as of December 2024. The legal half rests on the 2023 cybersecurity and cybercrime law and on a data protection regime under which controllers must notify the authority without delay and tell affected individuals where a breach poses a high risk to their rights, with public administrations separately required to report incidents as soon as they become aware of them.

What has been built since is instrumentation rather than defence. ANINF launched SecBOM in June 2025, a tool to map, control and protect the state's sensitive digital assets, an initiative driven from the Presidency and framed, like the rest of the national cyber effort, as digital sovereignty. The agency is working with the US-based MITRE Corporation on the design of Gabon's cybersecurity architecture (June 2026), an American technical thread in a country whose digital partnerships have not usually run that way. Gabon is not a party to the Budapest Convention; the agency's delegation to the Council of Europe's October 2026 conference was to explore the prospect of joining it.

Enforcement and assurance come mostly from outside. Gabon took part in Interpol's Serengeti 2.0 cybercrime operation alongside seventeen other African countries with UK backing (June to August 2025), and Banque de France information-systems auditors ran some fifteen workshops on cybersecurity and IT audit at BEAC, the central bank serving Gabon, in October 2025. Domestically, the field is convening: the second national Cybersecurity Forum, on protecting critical infrastructure, was held in November 2025 under ST Digital with ANINF, CN Consulting and BGFI Services. An accord between ANINF and Kaspersky provides for a competence centre in Libreville for threat monitoring, detection and analysis and for skills transfer, within a national strategy that also plans a CSIRT and a security operations centre (October 2026).

DPI

Data Exchange

Gabon's government interoperability platform was still being built in September 2026, one of four projects under way at the sixth steering committee of the World Bank-financed programmes on 8 September. No government body was exchanging data on it as of June 2024, against a target of five by 2026, and the platform itself had not been deployed. The framework meant to govern that exchange was unpublished on the same date, with adoption targeted for June 2026, and the World Bank's GovTech Maturity Index recorded no government interoperability framework of any kind in 2025. A 2025 ordinance requires public administrations to digitise their services and interconnect their systems, but the machinery beneath it is thin: Gabon has no dedicated body for data governance and no data governance strategy, and no data quality framework for government information systems, no monitoring of their uptime and nothing published on interoperability compliance (2025).

What does flow, flows point to point. Business registration data moves automatically from the investment agency's one-stop platform to the tax administration and the two social funds. The social insurance and pension system, by contrast, exchanges data with no other government system (2025). Coordination has existed since February 2021, when an inter-ministerial committee was created under the Prime Minister's office to coordinate all initiatives to digitise public administration, and ANINF ran a proof of concept in 2025 linking the tax, customs and treasury systems through a message broker, as a trial rather than a final technical choice. Passenger data is the newest flow: an advance passenger and passenger-name-record system run under a May 2026 concession with the US firm Securiport, financed by a US$30 levy on each international passenger, had its equipment installed at Libreville airport by October 2026 with commissioning still to come.

The identity layer is separated by design. A legal covenant of the World Bank-financed identity programme requires the biometric population registry, the civil register and the identity card database to remain functionally separate, and as of mid-2025 the institutions were still drawing up the operational roadmap to interconnect them through a common biometric reference.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Two years after Gabon issued its first electronic national identity card in June 2024, the interior minister told the National Assembly on 2 June 2026 that 335,384 people had enrolled, 164,944 cards had been produced and 147,224 collected, with 92,614 files still in processing and 78,500 classed as disputed.

Fewer than half of those enrolled hold a card: collections come to about 44% of enrolments (June 2026). Disputed files amount to roughly 23% of everything enrolled to June 2026, which makes data quality a structural feature of the build rather than an administrative backlog.

The card ended an eleven-year gap in national identity card issuance and rests on a 14-digit personal identification number whose enrolment Law 027/2020 makes compulsory for every person present on Gabonese territory, citizens and non-nationals alike. Registration and the attestation are free, as is the first card; enrolment opens at 16; the attestation is the prerequisite for applying for the card, which is valid for banking and administrative procedures. Behind it sits IBOGA, the biometric master database with automated deduplication, a project begun in 2012; the card and its digital identity management software and hardware are supplied by the French company IN Groupe (2024).

The World Bank results indicator for the share of Gabonese aged 16 and over holding a NIP stood at zero in December 2024 against a target of 90% by June 2026, and health insurance beneficiary records tied to a NIP stood at zero against a target of 250,000; most social insurance records remain keyed on the schemes' own identifiers rather than the national number (2025). The electoral roll is the exception: an online service returns a citizen's registration and polling centre against their NIP (2025). Three projects launched on 23 June 2025 — extending the biometric population register, a national digital identity system and a national civil registration centre — are the layer beneath the card, whose biometric processing the 2023 data protection statute allows the state only by decree after the authority's opinion, an opinion given favourably in November 2023 for extracting IBOGA data to issue the card. Public perception of how easy it is to obtain an identity document stood at 29.1 of 100 in 2023, 28th of 54 African states. Production of a digitalised driving licence began on 24 March 2026, and the transport ministry suspended enrolment on 21 September 2026 with nearly 7,000 printed licences awaiting collection in Libreville.

Digital Payments and Fintech

Gabonese bank cards are used to get cash rather than to pay: of 1,101,434 card transactions in June 2026, 62.41% were ATM withdrawals and 24.61% payments at merchant terminals. The estate behind that was 326 ATMs and 1,535 merchant terminals at end-June 2026, serving 457,377 cardholders among 673,793 bank clients, of whose cards 440,869 carry an international scheme and only 16,508 are domestic private-label.

The merchant terminal estate is nearly five times the size of the ATM estate yet carries under half the ATM network's transaction traffic (June 2026).

Mobile money is the wider channel, with Global Findex putting digital payment use among Gabonese adults at 66.5% and mobile money account ownership at 61.6% in 2024. The rail is regional rather than national: Gabon's digital payments build sits on the CEMAC GIMACPAY system operated through GIMAC and the central bank, live since July 2020 and connecting more than 91 direct and indirect participants including banks, mobile money operators, microfinance institutions, the treasury and the post office, and treating cross-border transfers within the monetary union on the same basis as domestic ones. BEAC owns 99.2% of GIMAC, chairs its management committee and acts as settlement agent (2023), so the central bank operates the payment system rather than only overseeing it. Its scheme rules are not public, and it has established no effective consumer recourse, its governance including no body representing consumers or low-income users (2023).

The state's own payments programme joined that rail in December 2025: MADIGIPAIE, launched to modernise public payments, lets people pay by mobile money by scanning a GIMACPAY QR code; more than 1,000 interoperable QR codes had reached merchants by December 2025, the scheme reached the TaxiGab transport network on 28 February 2026 and Libreville's mayor agreed in July 2026 to help bring it to the city's traders, practical terms still to be set; an October 2026 account put it at more than 3,273 merchants and 1,382 GIMAC QR codes in July, with no transaction volume published. On the revenue side the tax directorate reports at least 80% of tax revenue collected through its Digitax remote-payment platform (2024), with electronic filing and payment mandatory for medium and large enterprises since April 2024. Regional reporting is annual, through BEAC's report

on payment services in CEMAC, the latest edition covering 2024. The Council of Ministers adopted a bill ratifying and amending the digital payments ordinance, regulating payment-solution providers and moving payments progressively to digital form.

Registries

No administrative department in Gabon had a civil registration office registering vital acts digitally as of December 2024, against a project target of fifteen by June 2026. Registration remains paper-based and decentralised at the point of registration (2023), and Law 008/2022, which provides for a centralised digital and biometric civil register run by a new national civil registration centre, was still being put into effect (2023); the same law extends registration obligations to foreign nationals residing in or passing through the country. Gabon's civil registration score in the Ibrahim Index rose 12.5 points over 2014-2023 to 37.5 of 100, still 47th of 54 African states. An inter-ministerial workshop on putting the national civil registration centre into operation opened at Ntoum on 28 September 2026, the programme coordinator saying the rules for attributing identity must be decided before any platform is built.

The registers that function are electoral and commercial. The biometric population registry was to be seeded from the IBOGA biometric voter file of roughly 690,000 unique records, about half the adult population (2021); the electoral register held 846,822 voters before the August 2023 elections, 16,093 of them registered abroad; and the 2025 electoral code makes the roll a permanent national biometric file built from the national biometric register, registering anyone already holding a personal identification number automatically on turning 18. Company registration runs online through ANPI-Gabon's investment window, which handles registration, payment and issue of the single registration record, while the RCCM commercial register at the Ministry of Justice is still being moved online (2025), with the RCCM number and the taxpayer number issued within about 48 hours of each other.

Land and social registers are the weakest. Formal titling covers a very small share of land, the cadastre operating in practice only in urban areas (2012), and the government began modernising it in 2025 towards an integrated urban land management system. The unified social registry was still being built in May 2026, with World Bank technical support; on the government's own diagnosis the existing register of economically weak citizens is not reliable enough to target social protection, and a second census begins in September 2026. There is also no national standardised address register, so neither the land register nor the business register can be tied to an address database (2026). The preparatory workshop for the national civil-registration conferences closed with a diagnosis of badly kept archives, irregular data entry and a Civil Code dating from 1972 (2026).

Sectoral management information systems

Gabon's core financial systems exist but stop short of what they are usually built for: the integrated financial management information system is in use and custom-built, but its functional coverage is limited to treasury execution and its scope to central government (2025). The tax management system is custom software and exchanges data with other government systems, the customs system is off-the-shelf, also exchanges data, and customs and tax administrations are kept separate, and a debt management system is in use while there is no public investment management system at all. SIGFIP, an integrated public finance platform launched in January 2026, consolidates state payments and revenues behind a single interface connected to the Treasury, banks and electronic payment operators. On the personnel side the civil service's human-resources and payroll file, the Fichier unique de référence, in service for some twenty years, had been near-inoperative for several months by August 2026, blocking tenure confirmations, reclassifications, recruitments and promotions and forcing manual processing; on 25 August the vice-president of the government ordered an emergency restoration plan, and the civil-service ministry says it is migrating to an integrated state human-resources management system. The ministry reviewed the technical preparations for that system, SIGRH, on 12 October 2026: a single register of state employees to be interoperable

with payroll, budget and national identification, with the procurement tender the next step. There is no employee or manager self-service portal, and public-service HR records are not linked to the national identity number (2025), and the social insurance and pension system exchanges data with nothing else.

Health is the most built-out sector. DHIS2 was launched nationally in December 2024, but it sits at the aggregation and reporting level, with the register the primary data source in facilities and nearly all of those assessed processing their data by hand or with ill-suited tools; a national assessment of 71 facilities found only 45% possessed any digital tool for collecting and storing data (2022), and health facilities are compelled to collect data on paper records where computers, software and a reliable connection are lacking. The eGabon hospital information system reached two pilot hospitals from December 2023 with provisional handover in December 2024, and a second phase launched in 2025 extends it to eight more; health is also the one sector with its own interoperability framework, the CI-SIS. For education, the World Bank undertook in March 2025 to supply tablets and UNESCO proposed software for school data collection, with some schools already equipped, while police stations and gendarmerie brigades keep custody records on paper registers (February 2025). The courts are no further on: judgments, rulings and records are handled by hand (December 2025), and progressive digitisation of court registries is a 2026 priority of a Japan-funded UNDP justice project, with no system or timetable stated. Tax and revenue mobilisation is among Gabon's ten most deteriorated Ibrahim Index indicators, down 17.5 points over 2014-2023 to 30.8 of 100 and 46th of 54. The supplier of the Gabon Connect project presented the integrated customs operations system it is developing, whose first lot covers mineral clearance and the special hydrocarbons warehouse (2026).

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Gabon scored 0.5741 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, above both the Central African and the African averages, without having a national service portal at all: there is no one-stop shop, no government mobile application, no way for a resident to start a business online and no published performance data on online service delivery (2025). What works is sectoral. The tax portal is in use and offers taxpayer registration and filing, the social insurance and pension portal handles registration, benefits and payments, a government job portal offers registration and job search, and the Interior Ministry runs an online check of electoral registration and polling station by personal identification number (2025). Businesses selling to the state get less: there is no e-procurement portal, so tendering and contract award are not conducted online.

The newest service is a tourist e-Visa offered free for three months, a measure announced by the head of state and run through a platform developed in 2025 and presented by the immigration directorate, whose familiarisation sessions were run for tour operators, guides, travel agencies, hotels and restaurants, the last in Libreville on 31 July 2026 rather than for travellers; the announcement gave no dates for the free window, no application volumes and no platform address. Where an online channel fails, the explanation offered is load: applicants abroad were getting repeated rejections from the online NIP attestation channel, which officials at enrolment sites put down to a saturated network, with no rejection figures or resolution route given. Cameras to detect speeding, red-light and parking offences were installed across Grand Libreville in September 2026 ahead of going live, under a road-transport digitalisation project that provides for a national vehicle register and electronic ticketing; how notices will be served is not published.

Institutionally the picture is stronger than the service estate suggests. Gabon has a government entity focused on GovTech, a coordination body leading GovTech initiatives and an entity monitoring digital spending across government, though the institution's annual progress report is internal and unpublished (2025); ANINF's deputy director-general coordinates the World Bank-financed eGabon-SIS project and Gabon Digital programme, a ministerial meeting of January 2026 launched SIGFIP alongside electronic invoicing, a national platform for collecting public revenue and an extension of the Gabon Digital loan programme, and an ordinance published in

September 2025 gave e-government its first comprehensive legal basis. The single window itself, Gabon Connect, was presented to President Oligui Nguema in February 2026, and a government services portal was being prepared for a pilot across five ministries, with at least ten services to be integrated by December 2026. The postal company presented an application hosted in Gabon that combines payments, public services such as birth-certificate requests, postal services and insurance, its app-store launch still to come (2026).

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

ANINF opened its first provincial office, in Franceville in Haut-Ogooué, in June 2026 — the agency's first presence anywhere outside the capital since 2011.

Below that, the machinery of the digital state stops at the centre. No government body, national or local, was exchanging data on the planned interoperability platform, which had not been deployed (June 2024), and the inter-ministerial committee coordinating the digitisation of public administration, created under the Prime Minister's office in February 2021, sits above a layer that does not take part. The integrated financial management system in use is limited in scope to central government and in function to treasury execution (2025), and the unified budget classification and chart of accounts likewise cover central government only (2025) — so local accounts have no shared basis on which to consolidate with national ones.

The movement in the other direction is at the capital: the mayor of Libreville agreed in July 2026 to act as facilitator for MADIGIPAIE among the city's traders, while keeping the city's own revenue digitalisation system, built with the Treasury.

Rural digital data capture

Gabon has no score at all for the Rural Economy sub-category of the 2024 Ibrahim Index of African Governance, nor for any of its four indicators — rural land and water access, rural market access, rural economy support, and rural representation and participation — because the IFAD data the measures draw on are unavailable for the country (2023). The rural economy is, for measurement purposes, uncounted.

At the point of service the picture is consistent. Health facilities are compelled to collect data on paper records where computers, software and a reliable connection are lacking (2022). Police stations and gendarmerie brigades keep custody records on paper too, with digitalisation of custody records discussed as a future ambition and infrastructure limits flagged as a particular constraint in remote areas (February 2025). Civil registration is paper-based and decentralised at the point of registration, with a centralised digital registry positioned as a future state of the IBOGA identity project (2023). Schools are the exception in motion: in March 2025 the World Bank undertook to supply tablets, and UNESCO proposed software, for school data collection, with some schools already equipped.

The constraints under all of this are physical. Rural electricity access remains far below the near-universal urban rate (2023), a set of villages still has no mobile or internet coverage at all (February 2024), and the forest cover across most of the country means fibre cannot reach everywhere (July 2026). The second phase of the universal electronic communications service programme, financed by a special fund the telecoms operators pay into each year, was announced in February 2024 to extend coverage to 200 villages in all nine provinces, regulator teams with Moov Africa Gabon Télécom were identifying transmitter sites in remote villages in August 2025, and the digital identity programme carries an explicit rural coverage target alongside its gender one (June 2024).

Technology

AI

The newest artificial intelligence in service in Gabon is commercial and runs over the voice network: Moov Africa Gabon Telecom presented MIA on 21 August 2026, an assistant that answers spoken questions to anyone dialling 333 from an ordinary phone, with no smartphone or internet connection needed. The state has one of its own, a chatbot: the government launched Missamou on 15 July 2025, an assistant on Facebook Messenger that answers questions on official news, public services and administrative procedures. Beyond that, capability inside the state is at the training stage: two officials of the forward-planning directorate were trained in Lusaka in August 2026 in using generative AI tools to monitor and report on the African Union's Agenda 2063. No national strategy is adopted: preparatory work for one closed in Libreville on 30 September 2026 with 22 challenges and 36 recommendations from six working groups supported by the UN development programme, and drafting is the next step. A provisional UNDP AI landscape assessment presented to the workshop scored Gabon 1.9 of 5, and 1.7 on regulation and ethics (October 2026). The telecoms regulator ARCEP ran a national workshop on internet governance and digital sovereignty that took in artificial intelligence alongside cybersecurity, its president setting the aim of making the country a hub of digital soft power (January 2026), which is an ambition and not a deployment. The nearest thing to a domestic capability is teaching: the public Université Numérique du Gabon teaches computer science among its disciplines, in person and by distance learning (2025).

ICT Industry

The state has built no route by which a Gabonese technology firm can sell to it: there is no policy to support govtech start-ups or private investment in them, no government financing for innovation by small firms, no procurement rule favouring bids from start-ups or SMEs, and nothing published on start-up or SME support at all (2025). The domestic sector such policy would grow is thin, with Gabon outside the African fintech markets that draw sustained venture capital (May 2026), and the country's first Tier III data centre, opened at Nkok in July 2026, was built by a Cameroonian operator, though it is run by an entirely Gabonese technical staff.

Innovation ecosystem

Gabon's first national open-innovation programme was postponed within weeks of opening. Kimba Connect, launched in July 2026 to connect established firms to local start-ups so that corporate business problems become the specification for digital solutions, closed applications on 24 July 2026 with its final set for 4 August; on 6 August the Ministry of Digital Economy, Digitalisation and Innovation said it would move that date after concerns raised by participating start-ups, and a revised agenda of 11 August put the final at late September or early October 2026. Their objections were described only as concerning the programme's organisation. Selected firms were promised financial accompaniment, technology support, a quality label and facilitated market access, and on 14 July 2026 the state signed one accord against each of the two constraints it names, a guarantee mechanism with the Société Gabonaise de Garantie to share the risk banks carry in lending to young innovative firms and a skills accord with Huawei; neither has published terms.

The start-up population those instruments must grow is small and thinly capitalised. Counts of Gabonese start-ups run to roughly 150 to 200 firms (July 2026), and a commercial tracker listing about that many finds fewer than one in ten with any disclosed funding, and a single disclosed round in the year to October (2025): a EUR 650,000 round led by Saviu Ventures in the fleet-telematics start-up POZI, reported as the first foreign venture-capital deal for a Gabonese start-up (October 2025). The UN Capital Development Fund places the country in the third tier of African fintech markets, outside those attracting sustained venture capital (May 2026). Three innovation hubs and incubators — Akewa Accélérateur, the Société d'Incubation Numérique du Gabon and Ogooué Labs — operate alongside an active angel investor network (2025). The state-backed one is in question: the Société d'Incubation

Numérique du Gabon lost its director general after an audit and was placed under interim management in August 2026, with a state takeover, conversion to a parapublic entity or absorption into the national innovation centre under discussion. The former Woleu-Ntem governorate at Oyem is being converted into a pilot training and fabrication centre combining digital skills, robotics and entrepreneurship (September 2026).

Inside government the picture is an office without a plan. An established entity carries a public sector innovation remit, but no strategy or programme sits behind it and nothing is published on its results (2025), and there is no open source software policy or action plan for the public sector and no body that decides on adopting or procuring open source (2025) — closing off the cheapest route into a government system for a small domestic supplier.

Capacity

Literacy

Gabon ranks 2nd of 54 African states on equality in education, scoring 76.6 of 100 (2023), and 35th on whether pupils actually finish: its education completion score is 28.0 of 100 (2023), up 4.1 points over 2014-2023. Access is distributed unusually evenly by African standards, and what is being distributed evenly is a school system most children leave without completing.

The aggregate follows the completion figure rather than the equality one. Education, at 42.7 of 100 in 2023 and 40th of 54, is among Gabon's lower-ranked governance sub-categories, and it has moved 1.0 point in a decade — close to flat while the equality score slipped 0.5.

Two of the six education indicators cannot be scored at all: Gabon has no score for education enrolment or for human resources in education (2023), and the UNESCO data both draw on carry no value for the country. How many children are in school, and how many teachers stand in front of them, are therefore not answerable from the international record — which is a statement about the education ministry's reporting as much as about its schools. Work on the underlying collection has been running since March 2025, when the World Bank undertook to supply tablets and UNESCO proposed software for school data collection, and UNICEF and Airtel Gabon have supplied primary schools with tablets and connectivity (June 2026) for learning content.

On digital literacy specifically, the state adds nothing to what the schools do: no digital skills programme is freely available to citizens or to schools, and no results on digital skills are published (2025).

Training and skills

Gabon has no government strategy or programme for digital skills in the public service, no freely available programme for citizens or schools, and publishes no results (2025). The training that exists is therefore supplied by vendors, donors and universities rather than directed by the state, and the most consequential of those arrangements is the newest.

On 14 July 2026 Gabon signed a skills accord with Huawei Technologies Gabon, giving the company a technical accompaniment role for the Kimba Connect start-up programme: "salles intelligentes" for innovation, training in networks, cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and software development, and access to Huawei's own certifying training kits. Curriculum, certificate and equipment come from one foreign supplier, and the accord's terms have not been published — no room count, trainee target, cost or duration (July 2026).

The domestic pipeline is thin but real. The Universite Numerique du Gabon, a public distance-learning university, awards state-recognised degrees in disciplines that include computer science (2025), and the Universite des Sciences et Techniques de Masuku awards diplomas from technician to doctoral level in technological and

fundamental sciences. A 2025 workshop worked to embed UNESCO Global Skills Academy digital skills certifications into university curricula, alongside the UNESCO China Funds-in-Trust programme for higher education. What happens to the graduates is harder to see: the state's only visible instrument on that side is a government job portal offering registration and search (2025). A connected-schools programme using a digital learning platform moved to scale-up in September 2026, its pilot growing from nine schools to 69, with teacher training opening at Mouila.

Training also happens as a condition of using government systems. The tourism caravan's coordinators and DGDI closed a series of e-Visa familiarisation sessions for the tourism trade — tour-operator federations, guides, agencies, hotels, restaurants — in Libreville on 31 July 2026, and the second national Cybersecurity Forum met in November 2025 on critical infrastructure. Three identified innovation hubs and incubators also support founders (2025).

Research institutions

The Université des Sciences et Techniques de Masuku has awarded diplomas from technician to doctoral level under the licence-master-doctorate system since 2007. Founded in 1986, when the science faculty and the Libreville engineering school moved to Franceville, it calls itself the country's first scientific establishment.

Inclusion

Access to services

Gabon's suspension of social media was reported still in force on 6 October 2026, the presidency having defended it as temporary and conservatory at a Libreville press conference on 17 July 2026. That sits against a decade-long fall in digital freedom that ranks among Gabon's most deteriorated governance indicators (2023).

Price is not the tightest constraint on getting online: a gigabyte of mobile data cost about 4.09 US dollars in 2023, roughly 1% of monthly income per head, and residential electricity absorbs a low single-digit share of income per head at benchmark consumption (December 2025).

The documentary gate is tighter. Enrolment for the personal identification number is compulsory for every natural person present on Gabonese territory, citizens and non-nationals alike, and free of charge, and the 2022 civil registration law reaches foreign residents and even those passing through. Delivery is where it breaks: the online channel for a NIP attestation returned repeated rejections to applicants abroad from the campaign's opening in April, which officials put down to network saturation, and that falls hardest on them, since they have no counter to walk into instead. Electronic card issuance began in Libreville (June 2024), and thousands of finished cards were sitting uncollected by their holders (June 2026). Public perception of how easy an identity document is to obtain has improved markedly but remains low (2023).

There is no national online portal or one-stop shop for public services, no government mobile application, and no published performance data on online delivery (2025), though sectoral tax, social insurance and pension and job portals are in use. Nor is there any platform on which a citizen can lodge a complaint or an information request about service delivery, any published service standard, or any support for users with disabilities in the channels that do exist. At the redistributive end, the register of economically weak citizens is, on the government's own diagnosis, not reliable enough to target social protection (July 2026), which is why a new census was called, even as state-backed digital payment reached everyday taxi fares (February 2026).

Digital divides

Some 1,253 villages, home to about 117,600 people or roughly 6.5% of the population, had no mobile or internet service of any kind (February 2024) — an exclusion the national averages hide, since internet and computer access is among Gabon's most improved governance indicators of the past decade and its ITU development index score places it in the upper reaches of the African ranking.

The state has written the gap it means to close into its identity programme, which sets half of personal identification number holders to be women, and rural coverage of the number to reach the national rate by 2026 from a 2020 baseline of zero (June 2024). No Gabon-specific measure of the gender gap in mobile access exists to test the first of those against: the standard cross-country survey covers twelve low and middle income countries and Gabon is not one of them (2025).

Beneath the connectivity numbers sit harder floors. Rural households reach the electricity grid at a small fraction of the urban rate (2023), and the government's own framing of the connectivity problem is geographic — forest cover means fibre cannot physically reach everywhere. Availability is also not use: the great majority of mobile connections run on 3G or better (November 2025), while no measure of smartphone ownership in Gabon is published. And the state does nothing directly to lift the skills floor, running no strategy or programme of its own to build digital skills, in the public service or for citizens and schools, and publishing no results on them (2025) — an odd omission in a country that ranks near the top of the continent for equality of access to education, and the ministry's stated plan on skills is to strengthen the training institutions it oversees.

Data

National statistics

Gabon's new population census is not yet certified: in August 2026 the Constitutional Court sent teams to all nine provinces to verify the general population and housing census figures before deciding whether to approve them. The institutions behind it are being rebuilt at the same time, the Council of Ministers adopting on 18 September 2026 decrees amending the statistics institute's statutes and reorganising the National Statistics Council and the Special Fund for Statistics, the last to reduce dependence on external financing.

Gabon has run no agricultural survey and no business survey in ten years, and only one household survey and one labour survey in that period, against two health surveys (2023). The censuses have been done — agricultural, business and population, each within the same ten-year window — so the state takes a full count roughly once a decade and then goes years without the intermediate measurement that would tell it what has changed since.

The same pattern shows in the pillar scores, where data use and data products sit in the 50-69% band while statistical services, data sources and statistical infrastructure all sit in the weaker 20-49% band (2023): Gabon does more with what it has than it does to generate it. The direction is upward. The capacity of its statistical system scored 39.4 of 100 in 2023, 37th of 54 African states, a gain of 12.0 points over the decade and one of the country's ten most improved governance indicators. The second national strategy for the development of statistics, for 2023-2025, was validated in October 2023 at a cost of FCFA 50.26bn, and its period has ended with no successor on record.

The gaps are visible wherever an index has nothing to score: education enrolment and human resources in education carry no IIAG value at all, and neither does the entire rural economy sub-category. Administrative systems are not filling the space: the economy ministry's social-indicators dashboard for 2013-2021 records difficulty obtaining statistics from many sectoral administrations. The state's financial management system records no expenditure linked to the Sustainable Development Goals and carries no non-financial performance indicators for government

programmes (2025), so budget data cannot answer what the spending achieved; health reporting only went national on DHIS2 in December 2024, fed by staff transcribing paper registers. The government's own diagnosis is that its register of economically weak citizens cannot reliably target social protection, and a second census of that population is to begin fieldwork in September 2026.

Open data

Gabon has no open data portal publishing government datasets for reuse (2025), and disclosure of public records is one of its ten worst governance indicators, at 11.7 of 100 in 2023, 49th of 54 African states and barely moved across the decade. Access is the better half of the picture and the improving one — accessibility of public records reached 21.2 of 100 in 2023, up 7.7 points over 2014-2023 — but from a level that leaves most of what the state holds out of reach in practice.

What is published is uneven by domain. Government finance is the strongest category in Open Data Watch's 2024 inventory at 6 out of 10, with national accounts, trade, labour, prices, poverty, population, education and health facilities between 3 and 5, and energy at 2.5. Four categories score zero — digital connectivity, built environment, pollution and food security (2024), meaning nothing meeting the coverage and openness tests is published in them at all.

Of the sixteen transparency tests the GovTech Maturity Index applies, Gabon fails fourteen (2025): nothing is published on cloud usage, interoperability compliance, public investment projects, digital skills results, data governance, data protection complaints, regulator performance, online service delivery, right-to-information implementation, public sector innovation, startup support, government responses to citizens or public service standards. On the two it passes — digital transformation progress and GovTech institutional performance — reports are produced and kept internal.

There is no general right to ask for what is not published: Gabon has no right-to-information law, no body monitoring any such right, and no figures on requests received or granted (2025). The one enforceable claim on government-held data is personal, and only over one's own file — the 2023 data protection law gives an individual the right to ask in writing, free of charge, for confirmation of and a copy of data held about them. Nor is anyone in the state answerable for the question: there is no dedicated entity for data governance, no data governance strategy or policy, and nothing published on how government data is governed (2025).

Use of satellite data

Gabon's satellite policy work runs through communications: the country opened a national policy process on satellite communications at a seminar in July 2026 that brought AGEOS, ANINF and the regulator ARCEP together, framed as digital sovereignty and producing strategic recommendations for government. The case put there was geographic, resting on forest cover that fibre cannot reach past. For weather, Gabon hosts one of four regional stations retransmitting high-resolution meteorological satellite data, installed under the African Development Bank's SAWIDRA programme (2021).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

The American thread in Gabon runs through cybersecurity. ANINF and the US-based MITRE Corporation are jointly designing the country's operational and institutional cybersecurity architecture for critical digital infrastructure (June 2026), work still at the design stage. It follows the U.S. Department of State's cybersecurity capacity-building grant of about US$1.25 million to ANINF, running 2024-2025 and aimed at national cybersecurity frameworks, incident-response capability and digital resilience.

The other American strand is commercial. Gabon and Visa hold a partnership signed in May 2025, with a follow-up meeting in Libreville that July, directed at digitalising public services and modernising the state's collection of payments.

The World Bank is by some distance Gabon's principal digital financier of record, with close to US$200 million committed across four operations; the American grant is marginal beside it (August 2026).

China activities

Huawei is Gabon's standing technical partner at both the infrastructure and the skills layers, a position extended by a skills accord signed on 14 July 2026 that follows a broader digital-transformation memorandum signed in December 2025. The direction was set the year before, when Gabon opened an exploration of a strengthened technology partnership with the company on a ministerial mission to its sites in June 2025. Earlier again, a 2024 memorandum covering a smart-cities project and other digital services attached a large headline spending pledge to the relationship.

Everything Chinese on Gabon's record is a memorandum rather than a financing agreement, including the largest single figure in the whole picture, which is a pledge (August 2026).

EU activities

Europe's presence in Gabon's identity estate is French and contractual. The electronic identity card and its digital identity management software and hardware are supplied by the French company IN Groupe (2024). The firm's footing is older: as Imprimerie Nationale it signed a five-year partnership with the documentation and immigration directorate in November 2015, covering maintenance of the secure-title issuance platform it had delivered to the state in 2013 and an extension of the main supply contract for passports, visas, residence permits and refugee cards.

Gulf/UAE activities

The Gulf relationship runs through one firm. The Presidency records three memoranda signed in Abu Dhabi in February 2026 - mining, digital, and ports and logistics - of which the digital one renews an existing memorandum with Presight, a G42 subsidiary, to support digital transformation of the public administration and strategic State services using artificial intelligence, advanced analytics and big data, framed as reinforcing Gabon's digital sovereignty. No amount, term, deliverable or system name is stated, and no Gulf investment or data-centre commitment naming Gabon is on the record.

India activities

India is positioning rather than present. Its High Commissioner offered scholarships for public servants and a preparatory mission on cooperation in digitalising the public administration, and Gabon's civil service minister proposed framing it as a four-to-five-year capacity-building convention (April 2026), and India's own country brief records memoranda on holding a Joint Commission Meeting and on foreign-service training cooperation, an investment memorandum between the Confederation of Indian Industry and Gabon's investment promotion agency,

a 2007 housing line of credit and ITEC and ICCR training places (April 2026). Its digital record is the older Pan-African e-network, which set up tele-education and tele-medicine links in Libreville, and a draft memorandum on its e-VBAB successor reviewed in December 2020.

Digital sovereignty

Gabon's data protection authority has made hosting in the new national data centre a matter of Gabonese law: it authorised the ST Digital facility, with its main site and a mirror in Haut-Ogooué, after an impact study covering the location, purpose and security of the data it hosts (September 2026). The starting point was a country where about 95 per cent of the data generated was hosted abroad (July 2026). A second facility is state-owned: ACE Gabon SA, a state company, is building a 160-rack Tier III carrier hotel linked to the submarine cables, financed by the local banking sector and due between late November and early December 2026.

The state is writing control into what it builds: the 2025 digitalisation ordinance requires public digitalisation contracts to carry local-preference or local technological inclusion clauses, and the administration.ga platform, built by the local start-up Zaghi Digital with the Centre Gabon Innovation, leaves ownership of the source code to the administration free of charge (August 2026). Where the IBOGA biometric register and the identity-card database are hosted, and under whose jurisdiction, had not been published as at September 2026.

The terms on which the Presight memorandum, the Huawei memoranda and the IN Groupe identity-card supply govern data jurisdiction, portability and exit had not been published as at September 2026. The AI layer is at the proposal stage: after a Chinese government delegation's visit, La Poste's Charbonnages site in Libreville was named as a possible AI data centre for the applications the public administration uses daily, conditional on a Gabon-China partnership being finalised (September 2026).

Regionally, Gabon hosted Africa CDC's August 2026 workshop that set a roadmap for a convention on cross-border health-data sharing among the nine Central African member states.

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